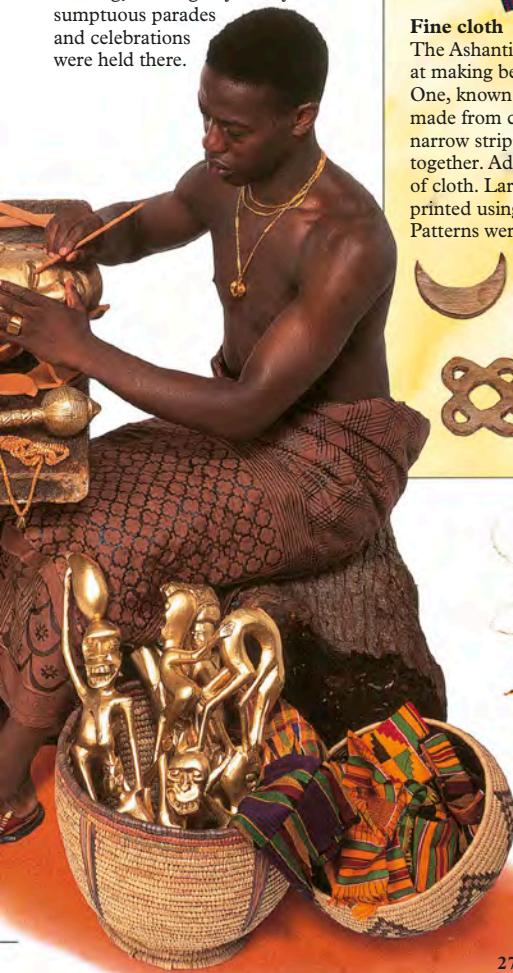




## Hub of the kingdom

Kumasi, the capital, was a teeming, bustling city. Many sumptuous parades and celebrations were held there.



Kente cloth



## Fine cloth

The Ashanti were experts at making beautiful cloth. One, known as kente, was made from cotton woven into narrow strips that were then sewn together. Adinkra was another sort of cloth. Large pieces of material were printed using stamps dipped in dyes. Patterns were built up in blocks or panels.



## Printing blocks

The stamps used to print cloth were made out of the shell-like fruits of calabash trees.



*Elephant symbols were used in Ashanti jewelry to show the power of the wearer.*



## Dripping with gold

The Ashanti wore rings on their fingers as well as gold bracelets on their wrists and at their knees.

